phones have made International Calls much easier and cheaper due to competition among service.

8.9.2. PBX (Private Branch Exchange):

A manually or automatically operated telephone facility that handles communications within an office, office building, or organization and that is connected to the public telephone network.

A PBX (Private Branch Exchange) is a telephone system within an enterprise that switches the calls between enterprises users on local lines, while allowing all users to share a certain number of external phone lines. The main purpose of a PBX is to save the cost of requiring a line for each user to the telephone company's central office.

The PBX is owned and operated by the enterprise rather than the telephone company (which may be a supplier or service provider, however). Private branch exchanges used analog technology originally. Today PBXs use digital technology (digital signals are converted to analog for outside calls on the local loop using plain old telephone service (POTS). Essentially a PBX is a telephone switch used by organizations and businesses. This device, functions in the same manner as a traditional telephone switch board but is scaled down to accommodate business settings.

A PBX includes:

- Telephone Trunk (Multiple Phone) lines that terminate at the PBX.
- A Computer with memory that manages the switching of the calls within the PBX and in and out of it.
- The network of lines within the PBX
- A console or switch board for a human operator (optional).

Modern PBXs are built around a small computer, and some of them can be connected to a server for additional services such as call management, call detail reports, telemarketing etc.,

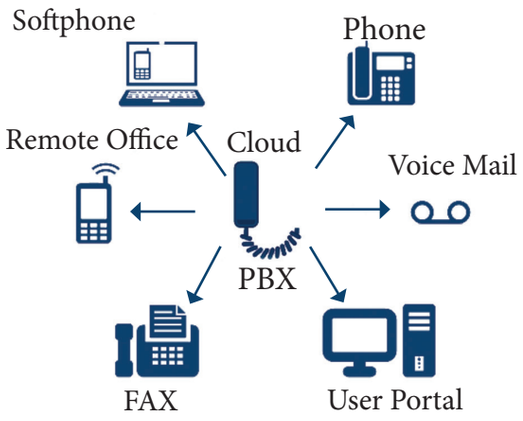


Fig. 8.5. Private Branch Exchange

The functions of PBX are as follows:

- Provide one single number that external callers can use to access all persons in a company.
- Distribute calls to employees in an answering team in an even way: using the Automatic Call Distribution (ACD) feature.
- Automatic call answering machine offers a menu of options from which a user can select to be directed to a specific extension or department.
- Allow the use of customized business greetings while answering calls.
- Provide system call management features.

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